Michael Hussey came in intent on staging a fightback after Irfan Pathan had picked up the two openers the previous evening. Anil had set a good field to Ponting and Ishant was given the ball. It was inspiring to see an Indian fast bowler bowl at real pace to one of the world's premier batsmen and mesmerize him with balls that came in from a good length.

The length Ishant was hitting was the key. I was standing at mid on and kept reminding him to bowl the same line and length over and over again. There was no need for anything fancy, as he already had Ponting in some difficulty. I could also sense Ponting trying to upset Ishant by threatening to come forward, to force him to alter his length. It was a true test between bat and ball and I was impressed to see Ishant stick to doing exactly what had been asked of him.

By the end of eight overs Ishant showed no reduction in pace. He had beaten Ponting on numerous occasions but somehow the batsman had survived. It was an important moment. If he managed to play Ishant off, Ponting would be able to relax and we would have missed an opportunity. Anil, however, was tempted to give Ishant a rest – until some of the senior players persuaded him to allow Ishant one more go at Ponting.

The gamble paid off and Ishant finally got Ponting to edge one to Rahul at slip. It was a just reward for a great piece of fast bowling. We had our man and could now have a crack at the Australian middle order. We kept taking wickets at regular intervals and in the end it was the left-arm seamer RP Singh who clean-bowled Stuart Clark to give us an amazing victory.

Reasons to be cheerful

After the game a number of bottles of champagne were opened in the dressing room and one was also sent across to the touring Indian media contingent, who had played a very important role in standing behind us during the Sydney controversy. I'm pleased to say that Brett Lee and Adam Gilchrist also came to our dressing room to congratulate us and it was a gesture that was much appreciated.

As I look back at the Perth Test a few things stand out. We arrived in Perth with a sense of purpose. We all felt hurt by what had transpired in Sydney and the best way to vent our anger was on the cricket field. And that is what we did.